

Solution-focused, not political. We're all Philadelphians solving a problem together.

The problem is in the system, not individuals. No blame, no shame. The system was designed for a different economy.

Shepherd mindset. Shepherds focus on solutions with love. Be the shepherd when advocating for LIFT. In the room with us? Share your fear, uncertainty, and doubt—we'll help you through it.

The Problem

For 10 years, Philadelphia's smallest businesses had a shield from BIRT (Business Income and Receipts Tax)—letting them start, grow, and support their families. **In 2026, that shield is gone.**

If in **2025** you earned **\$50,000** and you are a:

Laborer (1099)

Individual Enterprise

Family Enterprise

Starting in April 2026, your Philadelphia tax bill will increase by:

+\$1,208 — +\$3,746

That's between 1 and 3 months' rent for many Philadelphians—and they simply can't afford it.

85%

of all city businesses

That includes 122,000 Philadelphians who own and operate single-owner entities: contractors, freelancers, gig workers, nurses, barbers, food truck vendors, artists, retailers, and more.

The Solution

Create a **third tax class** for "Individuals and Single-Member LLCs whose sole member is an Individual"—ending double taxation on Philadelphia's small business economy.

What Changes

- ✓ Exempt from BIRT Net Income Tax (5.71%) — *this is the double taxation*
- ✓ Exempt from BIRT Gross Receipts Tax (0.141%)
- ✓ Still pay Net Profits Tax (3.74%) — only for Philadelphia residents

Result: \$1,208 becomes \$0. \$3,236 becomes \$0. (100% reduction)

Already confirmed: Solution has been reviewed and confirmed constitutional by Philadelphia Law Department. Critical that any solution passes the uniformity clause.

1 Start Conversations

Ask 3-5 solopreneurs you know:

"If you had to pay 1-3 months extra rent in taxes in 2026 and beyond, how would that affect your ability to care for yourself, your family, and your community?"

Then listen. Report back what you hear.

2 Connect Us

Who in your community is a trusted voice? Formal leaders AND informal networks matter.

3 Identify Testimony Voices

Who would be powerful at a City Council hearing? We need voices from:

- Construction/trades (plumbers, electricians)
- Food/hospitality (food trucks, catering)
- Healthcare (therapists, home health aides)
- Childcare providers
- Transportation/rideshare drivers
- Legal solo practitioners
- Barbers and hair stylists
- Media & journalism
- Creative (music, film, photo)
- Real estate & development
- Fitness & wellness
- Tech & innovation
- Arts & culture
- Reentry/second-chance entrepreneurs

Current Bill Status

- Bill introduced November 20, 2025 by Councilman Mike Driscoll
- Council President drafted bill and provided technical support for Fiscal Analysis
- Multiple council members engaged
- Finance Committee hearings expected: Late January / Early February 2026

Current Timeline

Today: Commit to 1-2 actions from above

Late Jan/Feb: Fill City Council chambers for hearings

Weekly: Check-ins — "Who did you talk to? What did you hear?"



Join the Coalition

liftphilly.org — Sign up, get updates, and add your voice